

Landing page: first-time home buyer guide — New Braunfels TX

SEO metadata

- **Target keyword (primary):** first time home buyer New Braunfels TX
 - **Secondary keywords:** buying first home New Braunfels, New Braunfels first time buyer guide, homes for first time buyers Comal County, starter homes New Braunfels TX
 - **Search intent:** Informational / Commercial
 - **Recommended title tag:** First-Time Home Buyer Guide | New Braunfels TX | Weichert Corwin (62 chars)
 - **Recommended meta description:** First-time buyer? Our step-by-step guide covers everything from pre-approval to closing in New Braunfels TX. Plus a buyer rebate program. Call (830) 632-5725. (155 chars)
 - **Recommended URL slug:** /first-time-home-buyer-new-braunfels
 - **Schema type:** FAQPage + HowTo
 - **Word count target:** 1,400+
 - **Estimated difficulty:** 30/100 (medium-low — KW NB and Emerald Haus have content, but it's generic)
-

H1: First-time home buyer's guide to New Braunfels, TX

The neighborhood you pick shapes everything. Your commute, your kids' school options, whether Saturday morning means a float on the Comal River or an hour on I-35.

A lot of first-time buyers in the San Antonio–Austin corridor are landing in New Braunfels right now. It's affordable compared to Austin, has more character than most San Antonio suburbs, and sits close enough to both metros that the commute stays reasonable. Below is the full process from pre-approval to closing day, with the details that matter when you're buying in Comal County.

H2: Why first-time buyers choose New Braunfels

Affordability that still exists

The median home price in New Braunfels is around \$339,000 in early 2026, down from peaks in 2022–2023. For first-time buyers, that correction opened doors. Homes priced between \$225,000 and \$325,000 are available in growing subdivisions and established neighborhoods throughout the city.

Compare that to Austin (\$475,000+ median) or even north San Antonio (\$385,000+), and the math speaks for itself.

Schools that perform

Both Comal ISD and New Braunfels ISD have earned Gold Performance Acknowledgements from the Texas Education Agency. If you're starting a family or planning ahead, the school quality here removes a major variable from the decision.

Location between two metros

New Braunfels sits on I-35, about 30 miles northeast of downtown San Antonio and 50 miles southwest of Austin. If your job is in either city, you can live here and commute. If you work remote, you get the space without the price tag.

A real community, not a subdivision

New Braunfels has its own downtown, its own culture (Wurstfest, Gruene Hall, river recreation), its own economy. When you buy here, you're joining a place with an identity that most suburban developments can't manufacture.

H2: Step by step — how to buy your first home in New Braunfels

Step 1: Check your financial readiness

Before you start browsing listings, get clear on where you stand.

Credit score: most conventional loans require 620+. FHA loans go as low as 580. VA loans have no official minimum, but lenders typically want 620+.

Debt-to-income ratio (DTI): lenders generally want your total monthly debt payments, including the new mortgage, below 43% of gross income.

Savings: plan for 2–5% in closing costs. On a \$300,000 home, that's \$6,000–\$15,000. Down payment varies by loan type.

Employment history: lenders want 2+ years of stable employment, ideally in the same field.

Step 2: Get pre-approved (not just pre-qualified)

A pre-approval letter tells sellers you're serious and capable. It's based on verified income, credit, and assets, unlike a pre-qualification, which is an estimate.

We work with local lenders in New Braunfels who specialize in first-time buyer programs, including:

- FHA loans: 3.5% down with 580+ credit
- USDA loans: \$0 down for eligible rural areas (parts of Comal County qualify)
- VA loans: \$0 down for veterans and active military
- Texas State Affordable Housing Corporation (TSAHC): down payment assistance for qualifying buyers
- Conventional 97: 3% down for first-time buyers with strong credit

Step 3: Define your must-haves

In New Braunfels, your budget shapes which neighborhoods are realistic.

Budget range	Where to look
\$200K–\$275K	East NB, Seguin-adjacent areas, some Canyon Lake lots
\$275K–\$375K	Central NB subdivisions, Gruene-area new builds, Spring Branch
\$375K–\$500K	Established NB neighborhoods, Canyon Lake waterfront-adjacent, acreage
\$500K+	Waterfront Canyon Lake, large acreage, custom builds

Think about commute direction (SA vs. Austin), school zones, flood plain status, and HOA preferences. Our agents live here. We'll help you sort signal from noise.

Step 4: Tour homes and make an offer

When you find the right home, we move quickly. We pull recent comps, put together a competitive offer, and negotiate price, repairs, closing cost contributions, and timeline. All contract paperwork and TREC-required

disclosures come through us.

Here's what the market looks like in early 2026: homes are sitting 74+ days on average, and over 70% have had price reductions. That gives you real room to negotiate.

Step 5: Inspection, appraisal, and due diligence

Home inspection (\$350–\$500): non-negotiable. We recommend local inspectors who know Hill Country construction, foundation issues, and well/septic systems common in the area.

Appraisal: ordered by your lender to verify the home's value matches the loan amount.

Title search: confirms clear ownership and no liens.

Survey: especially important for acreage or rural properties.

Step 6: Close and move in

Closing in Texas typically takes 30–45 days from accepted offer. You sign loan documents, pay remaining closing costs, and receive your keys.

If you're working with Weichert Corwin, you also receive our buyer rebate program as a closing credit. On a \$300,000 home, that's \$4,500 back to help with moving costs, furniture, or just padding your savings after a major purchase.

H2: First-time buyer programs available in Texas

Program	Down payment	Key requirement
FHA loan	3.5%	580+ credit score
USDA loan	\$0	Property in eligible rural area
VA loan	\$0	Veteran / active military
Conventional 97	3%	First-time buyer, 620+ credit
TSAHC DPA	Varies	Income limits, homebuyer education course
Texas VLB	Varies	Texas veteran or military member

Several of these can be layered together. A TSAHC down payment assistance grant on top of an FHA loan, for example, can reduce your out-of-pocket to nearly zero. We'll connect you with a lender who knows which combination works best for your situation.

H2: Common mistakes first-time buyers make (and how to avoid them)

Skipping the pre-approval. Without a pre-approval letter, sellers in New Braunfels won't take your offer seriously, especially when competing against other buyers. Get this done first.

Ignoring flood zones. Parts of New Braunfels, particularly near the Guadalupe and Comal rivers, sit in FEMA flood zones. Flood insurance can add \$1,500–\$3,000+ per year to your costs. Always check FEMA maps before making an offer.

Making out your budget. Being approved for \$350,000 doesn't mean you should spend \$350,000. Leave room for property taxes (Comal County averages around 1.8%), homeowners insurance, and maintenance.

Not using a local agent. National portals show you listings, but they don't tell you that a particular subdivision has a history of foundation issues, or that a "quiet street" is about to get a new commercial development next door. Local knowledge is the edge.

Forgetting closing costs. Budget 2–5% of the purchase price. On a \$300,000 home, that's \$6,000–\$15,000. Our buyer rebate helps offset this, but plan ahead.

H2: Frequently asked questions

How much do I need for a down payment on my first home?

It depends on your loan type. FHA requires 3.5%, Conventional 97 requires 3%, and VA/USDA loans require \$0. Down payment assistance programs through TSAHC can reduce your out-of-pocket further.

What credit score do I need to buy a home in New Braunfels?

Most lenders want 620+ for conventional loans and 580+ for FHA. VA loans have no official minimum, but 620+ is standard practice. If your score is below 580, there are steps you can take to improve it. Talk to us before you write it off.

How long does it take to buy a house?

From first search to closing day, most first-time buyers in New Braunfels complete the process in 60–90 days. The offer-to-close period itself is typically 30–45 days.

Are there neighborhoods in New Braunfels good for first-time buyers?

Yes. Areas east of I-35, newer subdivisions near Gruene Road, and parts of the Seguin corridor offer homes in the \$225,000–\$325,000 range with good school access and reasonable HOA fees. Our agents can point you to the best fits for your budget and lifestyle.

What is Weichert Corwin's buyer rebate?

We return a portion of our commission to you at closing as a credit — ask us about our buyer rebate program and how it applies to your purchase. [Learn more about the rebate →](#)

H2: Ready to start your search?

Weichert Corwin is veteran-owned, locally rooted, and has been helping buyers find their place in this community for years. If you want someone who knows the neighborhoods, the school zones, and the market, give us a call.

(830) 632-5725 133 N Seguin Ave, New Braunfels, TX 78130 [Buyer Rebate Program → Homes for Sale in New Braunfels →](#)

Internal link targets

- /buyer-rebate-new-braunfels
- /va-home-loans-new-braunfels (for veteran buyers)
- /homes-for-sale-in-new-braunfels-tx
- /canyon-lake-neighborhood-guide
- /gruene-neighborhood-guide
- /mortgage-rates

Sources

- [Zillow NB Market Data](#) — Median home price ~\$339K (2026)
- [Redfin NB Housing Market](#) — Days on market, price reductions
- [KW New Braunfels First-Time Buyer Content](#) — Competitor reference
- [Emerald Haus First-Time Buyer Guide](#) — Competitor reference
- [TSAHC Veterans Home Loans](#) — DPA programs
- [Summit Lending NB](#) — FHA/VA info